

Question:

A silicious rock contains the mineral ZnS. To analyze for Zn, a sample of the rock is pulverized and treated with HCl to dissolve the ZnS (silicious matter is insoluable). Zinc is precipitated from solution by the addition of potassium ferrocyanide $K_4Fe(CN)_6$. After filtering, the precipitate is dried and weighed. The reactions which occur are $ZnS + 2HCl \rightarrow ZnCl_2 + H_2S$ $2ZnCl_2 + K_4Fe(CN)_6 \rightarrow Zn_2Fe(CN)_6 + 4KCl$ If a 2 gram sample of rock yields 0.969 gram of $Zn_2Fe(CN)_6$, what is the percentage of Zn in the sample? Atomic weight Zn = 65.4, molecular weight $Zn_2Fe(CN)_6 = 342.6$.

Answer Choices:

- A. 10 % Zn
- B. 22 % Zn
- C. 20 % Zn
- D. 19 % Zn
- E. 15 % Zn
- F. 18 % Zn
- G. 16 % Zn
- H. 14 % Zn
- I. 12 % Zn
- J. 25 % Zn

Reasoning + Answer:

<tool_call> reasoning process here

We are given:

- A 2 gram sample of rock yields 0.969 grams of $Zn_2Fe(CN)_6$.
- We need to find the percentage of Zn in the original rock sample.
- The molecular weight of $Zn_2Fe(CN)_6$ is given as 342.6 g/mol.
- The atomic weight of Zn is 65.4 g/mol.

Step 1: Find how many moles of $Zn_2Fe(CN)_6$ are produced.

Moles of $Zn_2Fe(CN)_6 = \text{mass} / \text{molecular weight}$
 $= 0.969 \text{ g} / 342.6 \text{ g/mol}$
 $= 0.002828 \text{ mol (approximately)}$

Step 2: Each mole of $Zn_2Fe(CN)_6$ contains 2 moles of Zn.

So, moles of Zn $= 2 \times 0.002828 = 0.005656 \text{ mol}$

Step 3: Mass of Zn $= \text{moles} \times \text{atomic weight}$
 $= 0.005656 \times 65.4$
 $= 0.3702 \text{ g (approximately)}$

Step 4: Percentage of Zn in the sample $= (\text{mass of Zn} / \text{mass of sample}) \times 100$
 $= (0.3702 / 2) \times 100$
 $= 18.51\%$

This is closest to 18%

<answer> 18 % Zn </answer>